

Time Prepositions

A Quick-Reference Guide

Preposition Word Bank 2: Time Prepositions

"at" "by," "till," "until,"
"during," "all during," "throughout," "at" "around" "at around" "starting at"
"for" "up to" "for up to," "(for) at most" "(for) at least,"
"from" "(ever) since,"
"(well) before," "to," "(straight/clear) through to," "from,"
"on" "in" "after,"

Modifiers

"only (during)," "just (about)" "merely (until)," "(from) about,"
"somewhere (around),"

Patterns, Definitions, & Style

At By Until etc.

At = (one moment, only that point - start or stop; due at; but not a process)

By ≤ (a point within a range ending at a point; one point in time, **or an earlier** point)

Until/till = (process for a length of time **ending** at a point)

During = for a/within a whole period of time

Throughout/all-during = for **most or all** of a whole period of time

at around = a range of time centering on X

from/at/starting at = starting point

on = on the hour, every hour

For

For up to/at most = Maximum time - can be less

For (exactly, approximately, around) = amount of time - formal-exact-not more or less;
information-unclear.

For at least = minimum time - can be more

From, Since

since : only past tense

from: any time

- from now on
- from next week
- from last week

At, On, In

(at = clock time,) I will meet you for tea at 4pm, next to the lily garden.

(on = day of the week; full date YY/MM/DD) I will meet you on the 4th of June,
next to the lily garden.

(in = year; month; (month) of (year); #ed week; season; "the month of (May)") I will meet
you in 2065.

(nothing = next week; last week.)